

Paula Montano

Curriculum Vitae

✉ paula.montano1@gmail.com 🌐 github.com/paula-montano 🌐 paula-montano.github.io

Education

2021–2026* **Ph.D.** Politics and International Relations, University College Dublin
2019–2020 **M.Sc.** International Development, University College Dublin
2011–2016 **B.A.** Business and Foreign Affairs, Pontifical Catholic University of Ecuador

Research Experience

2021–today **PhD Researcher**, Dissertation: *Strategic Crisis Communication: Evidence from the Council of the European Union and National Parliament Negotiations*.
Advisor: Dr. James P. Cross, School of Politics and International Relations,
University College Dublin
2022–today **Contributor / Research Assistant**, Irish Polling Indicator,
University College Dublin

Research

Working Papers & Work in Progress

- *Exceptional Measures for Exceptional Times: Deciphering Emergency Politics in the Council of the European Union* (under review JEPP, selected presentations: EUI-ESM Conference on Crisis Communication, EPSA, PSAI)
- *Crisis as a Catalyst for Rebellion: Party Disloyalty and Grandstanding in Parliamentary Debates during Economic Crises* (draft available upon request, selected presentations: Seminar Series School of Politics and International Relations, University College Dublin)
- *Grandstanding under the Spotlight: Unveiling Elites Crisis Communication in the Council of the European Union* with James P. Cross and Yen-Chieh Liao (draft available upon request, selected presentations: APSA, EPSA, COMPTXT, SGEU ECPR)

Datasets

2025 **Irish Demographic Polling Datasets** with Stefan Müller and Thomas Pluck
Dashboard: <https://irishpoliticsdata.shinyapps.io/demographicpolling/>
Data: <https://github.com/Irish-Dem-Polling/datasets>

*Expected doctoral thesis submission August.

2024 **Irish Local and EP Election Manifestos** with Stefan Müller and Artur Baranov
Dashboard: <https://irishpoliticsdata.shinyapps.io/manifestoexplorer/>
Data: <https://github.com/stefan-mueller/iemanifestos>

Fundings & Awards

Total amount of funding: **€133,551**

2021–2025 **UCD Iseult Honohan Doctoral Scholarship**
University College Dublin School of Politics and International Relations
(covers full fees €49,284 and living stipend up to four years €80,999)

2025 **Research Grant**
School of Politics and International Relations, University College Dublin (€368)

2024 **APSA Pol Com Travel Grant Award**
Political Communication Section APSA Conference (\$500)

2024 **Vera E. Troeger Scholarship for Women in Political Methodology**
Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis
University of Essex (course tuition waiver £1,200)

2024 **Research Grant**
School of Politics and International Relations, University College Dublin (€750)

2023 **PEC Travel Grant**
Political Studies Association of Ireland (€800)

2023 **Research Grant**
School of Politics and International Relations, University College Dublin (€600)

2023 **Fellowship for Women in Political Methodology**
University of Basel (covers full tuition cost and accommodation)

2022 **Research Grant**
School of Politics and International Relations University College Dublin (€300)

Teaching

University College Dublin – Undergraduate level

2025 Head Tutor / Teaching Assistant, *Foundations of Political Theory* (CODE POL10180)

2022/23/24 Head Tutor / Teaching Assistant, *Research Methods in Political Science* (CODE POL20050)

2023/24 Head Tutor / Teaching Assistant, *Individuals and the State: The idea of Freedom in the History of Political Thought* (CODE POL20010)

2022 Teaching Assistant, *Introduction to EU Politics* (CODE INRL20160)
Guest lecturer, *Peer Review and Academic Writing Skills*

2021/22 Head Tutor / Teaching Assistant, *Foundations of Political Theory and International Relations* (CODE INRL10010)

Presentations

Conferences and Workshops

2025	European University Institute (EUI) - European Stability Mechanism (ESM) Conference on Crisis Communication, Florence, Italy
2025	School of Politics and International Relations Seminar Series, University College Dublin
2024	American Political Science Association Annual Conference, Philadelphia, PA, USA
2024	European Political Science Association Annual Conference, Cologne, Germany
2024	12th Biennial Conference of the ECPR Standing Group on the European Union, Lisbon, Portugal
2024	COMPTEXT Annual Conference, Amsterdam, Netherlands
2024	Discourse in the Data PhD Workshop, Duitsland Instituut Amsterdam, Amsterdam, Netherlands
2023	Political Studies Association of Ireland Annual Conference, Belfast, Northern Ireland
2022/2023	PhD Workshop, School of Politics and International Relations, University College Dublin
2022	Political Studies Association of Ireland Annual Conference, Waterford, Ireland

Summer Schools & Training

2024	Econometrics School of Social Sciences & Law, University College Dublin, (CODE: ECON41820 Audited)
2024	Ideal Point Estimation, Item Response Theory, and Scaling Methods for Surveys and Behaviour Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis, University of Essex
2023	Oxford Large Language Models (LLMs) Workshop for Social Science Researchers Nuffield College, University of Oxford
2023	Summer School for Women in Political Methodology Courses: R packages and Functions, Advanced Graphics in R, Web-Scraping, Text Analysis, Word Embeddings, Images as Data. University of Basel
2022	Introduction to Quantitative Text Analysis with R Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis, University of Essex
2021	Cert Higher Education Teaching Support University College Dublin

Skills

Language

English (fluent), French (fluent), German (intermediate), Spanish (native)

Computational Knowledge

Programming & Tools: R, Python, STATA, Git, GitHub, L^AT_EX

Methods: Natural Language Processing, Large Language Models, Machine Learning, Text-as-Data

Academic Service

2023/07–2025/08 PhD Representative, School of Politics and International Relations, University College Dublin
2022 Co-organiser, COMPTTEXT Conference, University College Dublin
2022 Committee Member Diversity & Inclusion for Ad Astra Applicant Pool, University College Dublin
2021 Conference Support, Political Studies Association Ireland (PSAI) Conference, University College Dublin

Other Experience

2020/03–2023/09 Consular Officer, Embassy of Canada in Ireland, Global Affairs Canada, Dublin, Ireland
2018/01–2019/02 Exports Trainee, Shipco Transports, Supply Chain and Logistics, Chicago, IL, USA
2015/02–2017/10 Passport Examiner/Consular Assistant, Embassy of Canada in Ecuador, Global Affairs Canada, Quito, Ecuador
2015/02–2017/10 Trainee, Canadian Chamber of Commerce, Quito, Ecuador
2015/02–2017/10 Trainee, Mexican Chamber of Commerce, Quito, Ecuador

References

Dr. James P. Cross
Associate Professor, University College Dublin
james.cross@ucd.ie

Last updated: April 29, 2026